

EG Geo-technology: US AI governance will stay fragmented and executive-driven through 2027

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US AI governance will stay fragmented and executive-driven through 2027

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* US AI policy is in a holding pattern—the deregulatory, executive-driven approach persists absent a triggering event that forces a Washington consensus—though President Donald Trump’s willingness to act unilaterally on issues like model access and infrastructure means the landscape can shift quickly even without one.

* Congress is on the sidelines, leaving states, courts, and executive orders to form the basis of policy and governance across trade, data flows, deployment, financial oversight, liability, and infrastructure.

* This report outlines the expected direction of US AI policy through 2027, covering national security, frontier-model oversight, federal and state legislation, and sector-specific regulation. Across all areas, a handful of key triggers — including a dual-use or cyber incident, agentic fraud, a breakthrough from China, or lobbying tied to frontier lab IPOs — could prompt sudden policy shifts.

President Donald Trump’s administration is prioritizing rapid AI deployment and competition with China, while relying heavily on executive authority, informal pressure, and national-security tools rather than more durable legislation. Congress remains unlikely to produce a federal framework, leaving states, courts, sector regulators, and executive agencies to shape the operating environment. The main risk for companies and investors is a series of abrupt policy shifts triggered by security incidents, China-related shocks, market failures, or high-profile harms.

This note assesses the likely trajectory of US AI policy across national security and frontier-model controls, federal and state legislative activity, and infrastructure and sector-specific regulation, identifying the plausible approaches in each area and their implications.

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